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Unit 4

Poem

Macavity – The Mystery Cat

T.S. Eliot

Warm Up

A. A French proverb goes thus: 'The dog may be wonderful prose, but only the cat is poetry.' You may have observed that all animals possess a number of unique qualities. Fill in the columns with words and phrases associated with each of the following animals.

DOG	CAT	WOLF	ELEPHANT

B. People admire some of these animal qualities. What are they? Have you noticed some of them in yourself or in others? Share your views with the class.

There is always an air of mystery in cats. They appear to see something which we don't. Macavity is one such elusive, agile and phantom-like cat. Read this humorous lyric poem and find out what happens when he strikes.

Macavity's a Mystery Cat: he's called the Hidden Paw
For he's the master criminal who can **defy** the Law.
He's the **bafflement** of **Scotland Yard**, the **Flying Squad's** despair:
For when they reach the scene of crime — Macavity's not there!

Macavity, Macavity, there's no one like Macavity,
He's broken every human law, he breaks the law of gravity.
His powers of **levitation** would make a **fakir** stare,
And when you reach the scene of crime — Macavity's not there!

You may seek him in the basement, you may look up in the air —
But I tell you once and once again, Macavity's not there!
Macavity's a **ginger** cat, he's very tall and thin;
You would know him if you saw him, for his eyes are sunken in.